

100 Days of Linux - Day 009

Title: Command History and Reusing Previous Commands

Today's Goal

Learn how to view and reuse previously executed commands using **history** and keyboard shortcuts.

Why This Matters

Linux professionals save time by reusing commands instead of typing them repeatedly.

Command of the Day: history

Syntax: history

Explanation: Displays previously executed commands.

Useful Tips:

Up Arrow = previous command

!number = run a command from history (observe only if comfortable).

Example: history

Beginner Lesson

Every command you type is stored in your shell history. You can review previous commands, scroll with the Up Arrow key, and avoid typing long commands again.

Practice Questions

1. Run at least five different Linux commands, then display your command history.
2. Use the Up Arrow key to execute your previous command again.
3. Create a file named history_demo.txt, then display your command history.
4. Count approximately how many commands appear in your history output.
5. Display your current working directory after reviewing your history.

Hints

Run a few commands before using history. Try pwd, ls, mkdir, and touch first.

Mini Challenge

Create a directory, create two files, list them, check your current directory, then use history to verify all commands appear.

Common Mistakes

Expecting a brand-new terminal to have lots of history. History grows as you use the shell.

Did You Know?

Your shell stores command history so you can quickly repeat common tasks.

Pro Tip

The Up Arrow is one of the biggest productivity shortcuts in the Linux terminal.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)

Q1: Execute any five commands then run history

Q2: Press Up Arrow then Enter

Q3: touch history_demo.txt && history

Q4: Review the numbered history output

Q5: pwd

Homework

Practice using the Up Arrow to rerun commands instead of typing them manually.

Next Day Preview

Tomorrow you'll learn how to combine the commands you've learned so far in a practical workflow before moving into file viewing commands.